

ارشاد



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BUSINESS PLAN
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1.0 Executive Summary

ارشاد is an innovative EdTech and HRTech platform designed to bridge the gap between education and employment in Egypt and the MENA region. Our platform offers a unique combination of task-based learning, portfolio creation, and job matching, providing a comprehensive solution for young professionals seeking to upskill and find meaningful employment.

We are seeking \$1.5M - \$2.5M in funding to develop our AI-driven platform, scale our operations, and establish partnerships with universities and companies. This investment will enable ارشاد to address the critical issues of youth unemployment and skills mismatch in the region, positioning us as a leader in the rapidly growing EdTech and HRTech markets

2.0 General Company Description

2.1 What business domain will you be in? What will your company do?

ارشاد operates at the intersection of EdTech and HRTech. We provide a comprehensive online platform that offers:

- Tailored learning pathways based on individual goals and skill levels
- Task-based learning opportunities from real companies
- Portfolio creation tools to showcase skills
- AI-driven job matching services

2.2 What Are Your Company's Goals & Objectives?

Goals:

- Become the leading platform for connecting education and employment in the MENA region
- Significantly reduce youth unemployment rates in our target markets
- Transform how companies find and hire skilled talent

Objectives:

- Attract 100,000 users within the first three years
- Establish partnerships with 20 universities and 500 companies in 24 months
- Expand to 3 new countries in the MENA region by year 3

Hint: Goals are destinations—where you want your business to be. Objectives are progress markers along the way to goal achievement. For example, a goal might be to have a healthy, successful company that is a leader in customer service and that has a loyal customer following. Objectives might be annual sales targets and some specific measures of customer satisfaction.

2.3 Describe your industry. Is it a growth industry? What changes do you foresee in the industry, short term and long term? How will your company be poised to take advantage of them?

The EdTech and HRTech industries are experiencing rapid growth, accelerated by digital transformation and changing workforce needs. Key trends include:

- Increasing demand for practical, job-ready skills
- Rise of the gig economy and remote work
- Growing importance of continuous learning and upskilling

ارشاد is uniquely positioned to capitalize on these trends by offering a platform that combines learning, task-based work, and job placement in one ecosystem.

2.4 Describe your most important company strengths and core competencies. What factors will make the company succeed? What background experience, skills, and strengths do you personally bring to this new venture?

ارشاد's key strengths include:

- AI-driven personalization for learning and job matching
- Unique task-based learning model that allows users to earn while learning
- Strong focus on the MENA region, addressing specific local challenges
- Comprehensive solution that bridges education and employment

2.5 Would you like to add any points...

3.0 Products and Services

3.1 Describe in depth your product or service you are planning to develop during the incubation period.

ارشاد's platform will offer:

- Personalized Learning Pathways: AI-driven course recommendations based on user goals and market demands
- Task-Based Learning: Real-world tasks from companies, allowing users to gain practical experience and earn money
- Portfolio Builder: Tools to create comprehensive portfolios showcasing skills and completed tasks
- Job Matching: AI-powered job recommendations based on user skills and company needs
- Certification Programs: Industry-recognized certifications validated by partner companies

3.2 What factors will give your products competitive advantages or disadvantages?

Advantages:

- Unique combination of learning and earning through task-based work
- Direct connection to job opportunities
- Localized content and focus on MENA region
- AI-driven personalization

Potential Disadvantages:

- Dependency on partnerships with companies for tasks and job placements
- Need for continuous updating of course content to match rapidly changing job market

3.3 What are the pricing, fee, or leasing structures of your products or services?

1. Subscription Fees (Individual Users): - Price: 300 EGP/month - Access to task-based learning, hands-on projects, and direct job placement opportunities.

2. Enterprise Subscription Fees (Companies): - Price: 1000 EGP/month - Access to a company-wide dashboard, employee training, skill assessments, and priority job placements for employees.

3. Task-Based Commissions: - Fee: 5% commission on tasks/jobs completed through the platform. - Applicable to payments received by freelancers or gig workers for tasks completed via ارشاد's platform.

4. Certification Fees: - Price: 500 EGP per certification - Learners can earn recognized certificates after completing specific courses or task-based projects, enhancing employability.

3.4 Kindly define your business model in the below table

Key Partners -Universities - Corporations & SMEs - Certification Bodies - Government and Career Development Agencies - Technology Providers	Key Activities -Platform Development - Marketing & Customer Acquisition - Partnership Development - Content Creation & Curation - User Support & Engagement	Value Proposition -Personalized Learning Paths - Real-World Task Experience - Job Placement - Affordable and Accessible - Employer Certifications - Automated Portfolio	Customer Relationship -Self-Service Platform - Customer Support - Partnership Engagement - Community Building	Customer Segment Primary Market (Individuals): 1. University Students & Recent Graduates (Aged 18-25) 2. Freelancers & Early-Career Professionals (Aged 25-35) 3. Career Switchers (Aged 25-35) Secondary Market (Companies): 1. Startups & SMEs 2. Large Enterprises
	Key Resources - Technology Platform - Content - Human Capital - Financial Resources - Partnerships		Channels -Website & Mobile App - Social Media - University Partnerships - Career Fairs & Events - Digital Marketing	
Cost Structure - Platform Development & Maintenance - Marketing & User Acquisition -Operations & Hiring -Legal, Compliance, and Administrative Costs			Revenue Streams - Subscription Fees - Task-Based Commissions - Enterprise Subscriptions - Certification Fees	

4.0 Project milestones

4.1 List your project milestones (mentioning time period)

Milestone Description	Deadline of Accomplishment (assuming that the beginning of incubation is month 1)
Prototype Development (MVP)	Month 2
Platform Testing and Beta Launch	Month 4
Initial User Acquisition (First 500 users)	Month 6
Corporate Partnerships for Job Placements	Month 7
Full Product Launch (All core features live)	Month 12
Certification Program Launch	Month 15
Scale Marketing and User Growth (2,000+ users)	Month 18
First Revenue from Subscriptions/Commissions	Month 20
Expand Partnerships with Universities	Month 24

5.0 Marketing Plan

5.1 Did you conduct any market research (primary or secondary)? if yes, please specify and mention your findings

Key findings from our market research include:

- 60% of Egypt's population is under 30, providing a large target market
- Youth unemployment rate in Egypt is around 23%
- Growing demand for practical, job-ready skills in tech, digital marketing, and design
- Increasing adoption of online learning and remote work

5.2 What is the total size of your product market approximately ? What is the percent share of the market will you acquire ? And what is the current demand in target market.

ارشاد's primary target markets are:

- University Students & Recent Graduates (18-25 years old)
- Freelancers & Early-Career Professionals (25-35 years old)
- Career Switchers (25-35 years old)
- Startups, SMEs, and Large Enterprises seeking skilled talent

5.3 What is the growth potential and opportunity for a business of your size.

The EdTech and HRTech markets in the MENA region are projected to grow significantly in the coming years. With our unique offering, ارشاد is well-positioned to capture a substantial market share. The opportunity lies in addressing the skills gap between education and employment, which is a critical issue in the region.

5.4 What entry barriers do you face in entering this market with your new company?

Some key entry barriers we face include:

- Establishing trust with both users and companies in a new market
- Building a critical mass of users and companies to create a viable marketplace
- Navigating complex regulatory environments across different MENA countries
- Competing with established global players and local incumbents
- Initial investment required for platform development and marketing

5.5 Identify your targeted customers and their demographics

1. University Students & Recent Graduates:

- Age: 18-25 years old
- Location: Primarily in Egypt and other MENA countries
- Education: Currently pursuing or recently completed higher education
- Tech-savvy and familiar with online learning platforms
- Seeking practical skills and job opportunities

2. Freelancers & Early-Career Professionals:

- Age: 25-35 years old
- Location: MENA region, with a focus on urban areas
- Education: Varied, often with some college or professional training
- Experience: 0-5 years of work experience
- Looking to enhance skills or find more stable work opportunities

3. Career Switchers:

- Age: 25-35 years old
- Location: MENA region
- Education: Often have a degree or professional qualification in another field
- Motivated to learn new skills for career transition

1. Companies (B2B Customers):

- Size: Range from startups and SMEs to large enterprises
- Industries: Focus on tech, digital marketing, design, and other high-growth sectors
- Location: Based in Egypt and other MENA countries
- Needs: Seeking skilled talent for project-based work or full-time positions

5.6 What products and companies will compete with you? Please list your major competitors (whether global or local)

Major competitors include:

Global Competitors:

- LinkedIn Learning: Offers a wide range of courses but lacks task-based learning and direct job placement
- Coursera: Partners with universities for high-quality courses but doesn't provide real-world task experience
- Upwork & Fiverr: Major freelancing platforms but limited in skill development offerings

Local Competitors:

- Nafham (Egypt): Provides online educational resources but focuses more on academic learning
- Wuzzuf (Egypt): Leading job board in Egypt but doesn't offer skills training or task-based learning
- Edraak (Jordan): Offers free online courses but lacks job placement and task-based learning features

5.7 kindly Use the Competitive Analysis table below to compare your company with your two most important competitors (please list all of your product/ service features)

Competitor	Strengths	Weaknesses	Price	Quality	Importance To Customer
ارشاد	Task-based learning, real-world experience, direct job placement, holistic approach combining learning and earning.	- Limited traction in global markets (early stage) - Need for larger enterprise clients	Subscription: 300 EGP/month	High-quality, practical, and job-oriented.	1 (critical: job-relevant skills & placement)
LinkedIn Learning	Wide range of courses in tech, business, and personal development.	Focuses more on theory, lacks hands-on task-based learning and direct job placement.	Subscription: \$29.99/month	High-quality theoretical courses, lacks practical learning.	2 (important for affordability and flexibility)
Coursera	Partners with top universities, high-quality courses and certifications.	No direct job opportunities, lacks real-world task-based learning.	Free for many courses; paid certificates starting at ~\$39.	High-quality academic courses, recognized certifications	2 (critical: quality of learning and work opportunities)
Wuzzuf	Leading job board in Egypt, connects job seekers with employers.	Focuses on job placements, no skills training or practical experience.	Free	High-quality job board, lacks learning opportunities.	1
Edraak	Free online	Lacks job	Free	High-quality	3

	courses, strong focus on the Arab-speaking audience.	placement features and task-based learning opportunities.		educational content for general knowledge.	
Nafham	Provides educational resources and courses for students, MENA-focused.	More academic focus, lacks job-ready skill development and practical task-based learning.	Free	Moderate, academic-focused content.	3
Upwork & Fiverr	Large platforms connecting freelancers with businesses globally.	Limited focus on skill-building or educational features, no structured learning pathways.	10-20% commission on earnings	Service quality depends on freelancers, no learning system.	1

Hint: in the second and third columns, you may check whether you think this factor will be a strength or a weakness for you. In the importance to customer column, estimate the importance of each competitive factor to the customer. 1 = critical; 5 = not very important.

6.0 Management Team

Management Team Members

6.1 Who will be the key members of your management team(kindly list the names and titles of the management team)? Briefly describe their background (education, working experience) and their roles of responsibilities

Key management roles include:

- Founder & CEO: Abdelrahman Sherif
- project manager: Ahmed Elsayed
- Business Developer: Momen Gamal
- Developers:
 - Frontend: Abdallah Hamada
 - Backend: Mariam Elharizy
 - UI&UX Designer: Nour Esmail

Hint: Who will manage the organization and who will be in the organizational structure?

Management Team Gaps

6.2 What positions do you still need to hire, in order to run your business? And how are you planning to do it.

Management Team Gaps

Positions to be filled:

- Data Scientist (AI & Personalization)
- Head of Sales (For Corporate Clients)
- Legal Counsel
- Human Resources Manager

7.0 Financials

Funding Requirements/Use of Funds

7.1 How much money do you require to start and/or run your business? What will be the primary uses of these funds? And how to you plan to secure your required funds

Funding Requirements/Use of Funds

ارشاد is seeking 360K in funding. The primary uses of these funds will be:

- Platform Development & Maintenance: 144K EGP
- Marketing & User Acquisition: 108K EGP
- Operations & Hiring: 72K EGP
- Legal, Compliance, and Administrative Costs: 36K

7.2 Kindly provide your financial plan

Our financial plan includes multiple revenue streams:

- Subscription fees from individual users (300 EGP)
- Commissions on task-based work and job placements (5%)
- Enterprise subscriptions from companies (1000 EGP)
- Certification fees (500 EGP per certification)

7.3 Define the risks your project might face and the what is your contingency plan?

1. Market Competition:

- Risk: Competing with established global players like Coursera, LinkedIn Learning, and Upwork, as well as local platforms like Wuzzuf and Edraak.
- Mitigation:
 - Differentiation: Focus on ارشاد's unique value proposition—combining task-based learning, earning opportunities, and employer-validated certifications. This hybrid approach offers users a more practical, job-focused experience.
 - Localized Content: Tailor content and opportunities specifically to the Egyptian and MENA market, addressing unique unemployment challenges and skills gaps.
 - Partnerships: Build strong partnerships with local universities, companies, and government entities to ensure ارشاد stands out as a trusted local solution.

2. Regulatory Challenges:

- Risk: Compliance with local labor laws, education regulations, and data protection policies in Egypt and other MENA countries.
- Mitigation:

- Legal Counsel: Hire a dedicated legal expert to handle all regulatory requirements, especially around data privacy, contract law, and employment regulations.
 - Compliance Management: Implement a compliance management system to stay updated on changes in local regulations and adapt quickly to legal challenges.
3. Slow User Adoption:
- Risk: Difficulty in acquiring a critical mass of users (both individuals and companies) needed to create a successful two-sided marketplace.
 - Mitigation:
 - Freemium Model: Offer a free tier to attract early users and reduce friction in onboarding. Use an aggressive marketing strategy, particularly on social media and through university partnerships.
 - Referral Programs: Implement user referral programs to encourage organic growth through word-of-mouth, with incentives for both individuals and companies.
 - University Partnerships: Secure long-term partnerships with universities to funnel students and graduates directly into the platform.
4. Technical Failures or Delays:
- Risk: Delays in platform development or issues with platform stability, which could affect user experience and growth.
 - Mitigation:
 - Agile Development: Adopt an agile development approach to build and iterate the platform in phases. This allows for continuous feedback from users and reduces the risk of large-scale technical issues.
 - Backup Systems: Ensure backup infrastructure and cloud-based solutions to minimize downtime and data loss in case of technical failures.

7.4 Define your key assumptions

1. Market Assumptions:
- Assumption: There is a growing demand for task-based learning and flexible work opportunities in the Egyptian and broader MENA market.
 - Reasoning: Rising youth unemployment, increased adoption of digital learning, and the rise of the gig economy suggest that young professionals are seeking new ways to upskill and earn money.
2. Technology Assumptions:
- Assumption: Users have sufficient access to internet and digital devices to participate in online training and remote tasks.
 - Reasoning: Egypt's internet penetration is over 50%, and mobile internet usage is high, making digital platforms accessible to the target audience.
3. Financial Assumptions:
- Assumption: Users and companies are willing to pay for subscriptions or commissions on tasks once they see the value.

- Reasoning: Based on market research, many young professionals are willing to invest in education, and companies are eager to reduce hiring costs by outsourcing to skilled workers on flexible terms.

4. Growth Assumptions:

- Assumption: The platform can achieve significant user growth by leveraging digital marketing, university partnerships, and job fairs.
 - Reasoning: The target demographic is highly active on social media and is increasingly relying on online platforms for learning and job opportunities.

5. Competitive Advantage Assumptions:

- Assumption: The combination of personalized learning, task-based earning, and job placement gives the platform a unique position in the market.
 - Reasoning: Most competitors focus on either online education or job boards, but ارشاد uniquely offers both, combined with practical experience through task-based learning.

6. Partner Assumptions:

- Assumption: Companies will be interested in using the platform to access pre-vetted, skilled workers for flexible tasks and projects.
 - Reasoning: Companies, especially startups and SMEs, are looking for cost-effective ways to hire skilled talent, and the platform offers a way to test candidates through task completion before making hiring decisions.